Day 31 - Songbird, Paris Morain

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Caledon Hills section · hike 39 · Song Bird Nature Reserve & Paris Moraine

12.2 km / 7.6 mi	~3.4 h	2.6 km new	48 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive each way, Sat 7 am

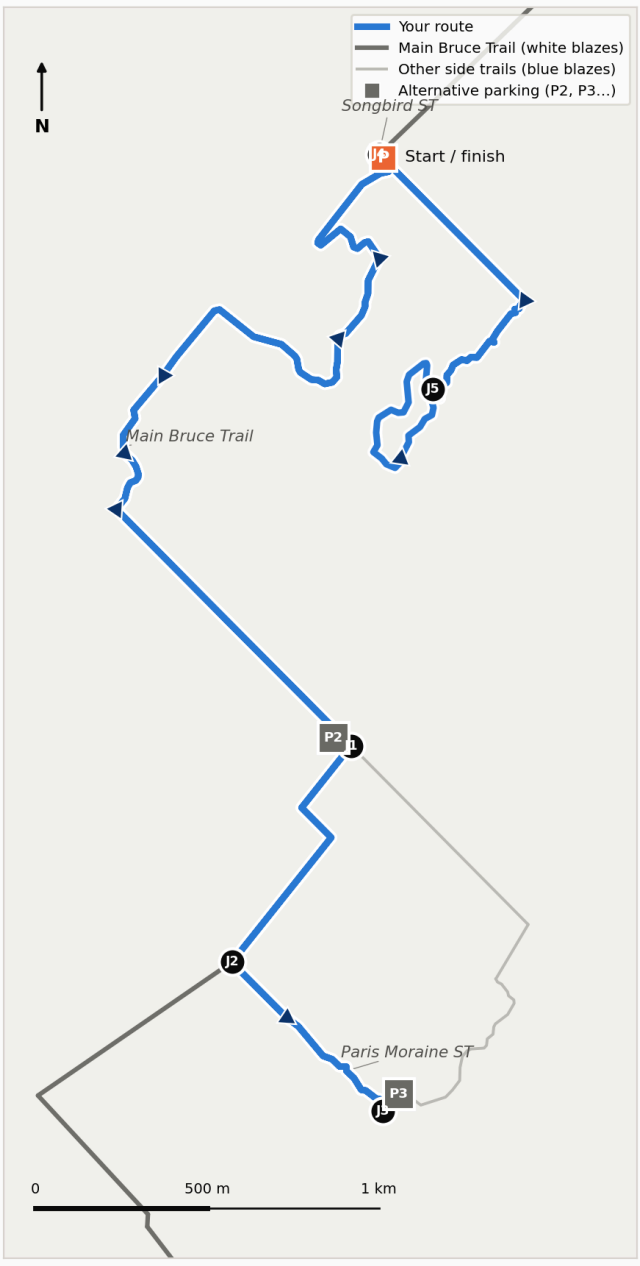
Park (P): Roadside parking on the west side of Airport Road, across from Finnerty Sideroad. Google Maps. **Free**

Navigate: import *day31_hike039.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: Songbird Side Trail (1.9 km); Paris Morain Side Trail (0.7 km)

Route map

Day 31 | 12.2 km (7.6 mi)



What to expect

- **Parking:** roadside on the west side of Airport Road, across from Finnerty Sideroad. Airport Road is busy, so load the dog on the side away from traffic.
- **Road walking:** since the main Trail moved off Airport Road in 2025, the Songbird Side Trail is no longer connected to it, and you walk a stretch of road shoulder to reach it. Several shorter main-Trail stretches also follow road shoulders. Keep the dog close.
- **Songbird Side Trail:** passes through mature sugar maple forest, hedgerows and thickets, and old farm meadow now in native grasses. It's an eBird hotspot; listen for Indigo Bunting, Brown Thrasher, Bobolink and Eastern Meadowlark. Volunteers hauled out two bins of scrap metal in 2012, the year the trail was blazed.
- **Paris Moraine Side Trail:** hummocky glacial terrain of knobs, ridges and wet hollows (kettles) left by the retreating ice sheet about 13,000 years ago. It was once part of the main Trail and was named in 2025.
- **Dogs:** allowed on leash. Keep the dog on the trail in the meadows, where ground-nesting birds like Bobolink live.

Parking options

	Alternative parking	Parking cost	Route km	Walk to trail	Closest side trails
P2	Roadside parking on Mountainview Rd at the Mountainview Road Access Trail map	Free	3.2	0 m	

P3	There are a number of roadside parking opportunities along Escarpment Sideroad where wide... map	Free	4.6	50 m	Paris Morain

Can't do it all in one go? Split it into two shorter outings: **Outing 1** from the planned parking (P): 3.0 km / 1.9 mi, covering Songbird. **Outing 2** from P3 (There are a number of roadside parking opportunities along Escarpment Sideroad where wide...; Free): 1.4 km / 0.9 mi, covering Paris Morain. The website's map shows which parts are already done.

Parking costs were checked in October 2026 from operator websites and Bruce Trail Conservancy data; prices and booking rules change, so check before you go.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions
0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: Roadside parking on the west side of Airport Road, across from Finnerty Sideroad. Head south on the white-blazed main Bruce Trail.
2.2	1.4	Heads-up: The next 1.0 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
3.1	2.0	J1: Junction. Turn right to stay on the main Bruce Trail, heading south-west. (the blue-blazed Paris Moraine Side Trail goes off ahead.) There is trailhead parking here (Roadside parking on Mountainview Rd at the Mountainview Road Access Trail).
4.0	2.5	J2: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Paris Moraine Side Trail, heading south-east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead.)
4.6	2.9	J3: Turnaround point. Turn around and retrace your steps.
5.2	3.3	J2: Turn right onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading north-east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
6.1	3.8	J1: Junction. Turn left to stay on the main Bruce Trail, heading north-west. (the blue-blazed Paris Moraine Side Trail goes off on your right.) There is trailhead parking here (Roadside parking on Mountainview Rd at the Mountainview Road Access Trail). The next 1.0 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
9.2	5.7	J4: You pass the start again. Keep going on the blue-blazed Songbird Side Trail, heading south-east.
10.3	6.4	J5: Junction. Turn sharp left to stay on the Songbird Side Trail, heading south. (the blue-blazed Songbird Side Trail goes off ahead.) This is a short excursion (about 810 m in all): walk the whole Songbird Side Trail, including the short loop or branch near its end (see the map), and come back to this junction.
11.1	6.9	J5: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the Songbird Side Trail, heading south-east. (the Songbird Side Trail you already walked goes off on your right.)
11.6	7.2	Heads-up: The next 0.6 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
12.2	7.6	Back at the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on the Caledon Hills Bruce Trail Club's Songbird and Paris Moraine side-trail stories.